PREMIER LEAGUE 2026/27 · MATCHWEEK 10

Sunderland v Chelsea

Stadium of Light, Sunderland · November 8, 2026 (Sunday) · Kickoff 8:00 AM Central / 14:00 UK

OFFICIAL STARTING XI

NO.	PLAYER / POSITION	FROM	AT CHELSEA	PREVIOUSLY	PLAYING STYLE	KEY STATS
– GK	**Mike Penders** GOALKEEPER	Belgium	Signed 2025; first-team squad from 2026 after a…	Genk; Strasbourg (loan)	Tall, quick off his line and comfortable with the ball at his feet.	2025–26, STRASBOURG (LOAN) 33 Ligue 1 apps, 50 apps all comps
2 RB	**Marco Palestra** RIGHT WING-BACK	Italy	July 2026, roughly £43–50m from Atalanta — contract to…	Atalanta; Cagliari (loan, 2025/26)	A lung-busting, up-and-down right wing-back with enormous repeat-sprint volume.	2025–26, CAGLIARI (LOAN) 37 Serie A apps, 4 assists
29 CB	**Wesley Fofana** CENTRE-BACK	France	Since Aug 2022, about £70m from Leicester City	Leicester City; Saint-Étienne	Quick, aggressive and front-footed, strong in single combat and comfortable defending a high line.	2025–26, CHELSEA 25 apps, 1,727 minutes
6 CB	**Levi Colwill** LEFT CENTRE-BACK	England	Academy from 2012; first team since 2023 — 4th senior…	Chelsea academy; Huddersfield Town & Brighton (loans)	Left-footed, unflustered, progresses the ball through the left channel rather than sideways around it.	2025–26, CHELSEA — ACL RECOVERY 4 apps
– LB	**Pep Chavarría** LEFT WING-BACK	Spain	July 2026 from Rayo Vallecano	Rayo Vallecano; Real Zaragoza	Attacking left wing-back with a reliable delivery and real stamina up and down the flank.	2025–26, RAYO VALLECANO 2 assists, 33 apps
14 CM	**Jordan Henderson** CENTRAL MIDFIELD	England	Summer 2026, from Brentford	Brentford; Ajax; Al-Ettifaq; Liverpool; Sunderland; Coventry…	Veteran organiser and senior voice rather than a ball-carrier — screens in front of the defence, sets the tempo with early sideways and forward…	2025–26, BRENTFORD 34 apps
25 CM	**Moisés Caicedo** CENTRAL MIDFIELD	Ecuador	Since Aug 2023, £100m plus add-ons — 4th season	Brighton; Beerschot (loan); Independiente del Valle	The engine.	2025–26, CHELSEA 84 tackles, 33 apps
45 CM	**Roméo Lavia** CENTRAL MIDFIELD	Belgium	Since Aug 2023 from Southampton	Southampton; Manchester City academy; Anderlecht academy	Press-resistant holding midfielder who turns out of pressure and keeps the ball moving in tight areas.	2025–26, CHELSEA — INJURY-HIT 8 apps
10 AM	**Cole Palmer** ATTACKING MIDFIELD	England	Since Sept 2023, £40m — 4th season	Manchester City (academy and first team)	Left-footed, drifts inside from the right, arrives late into the box, ice-cold from the penalty spot.	2025–26, CHELSEA 10 goals, 1 assist
17 AM	**Morgan Rogers** ATTACKING MIDFIELD	England	July 2026, £117m ($157m) from Aston Villa — club record…	Aston Villa; Middlesbrough; Manchester City academy; loans…	Powerful, low-slung ball carrier who takes possession on the half-turn and drives straight at defenders, and presses like a midfielder.	2025–26, ASTON VILLA 10 goals, 6 assists
7 ST	**Pedro Neto** WINGER	Portugal	Since July 2024, about £54m from Wolves	Wolverhampton Wanderers; Lazio; Braga academy	Direct, one-v-one dribbler who attacks the byline and cuts back.	2025–26, CHELSEA 5 goals, 6 assists

Official starting XI, confirmed 7:06 AM CT. Last updated November 8, 2026, 7:06 AM CT. chelsea-fc-2026-27.netlify.app